Three guessed variables do not suffice at ℓ = 8 for this set

These are the results of `research/dreg_closure_guess3_20261023/`; the full text is in `RESULTS.md`. **Class:** stage diagnostic.

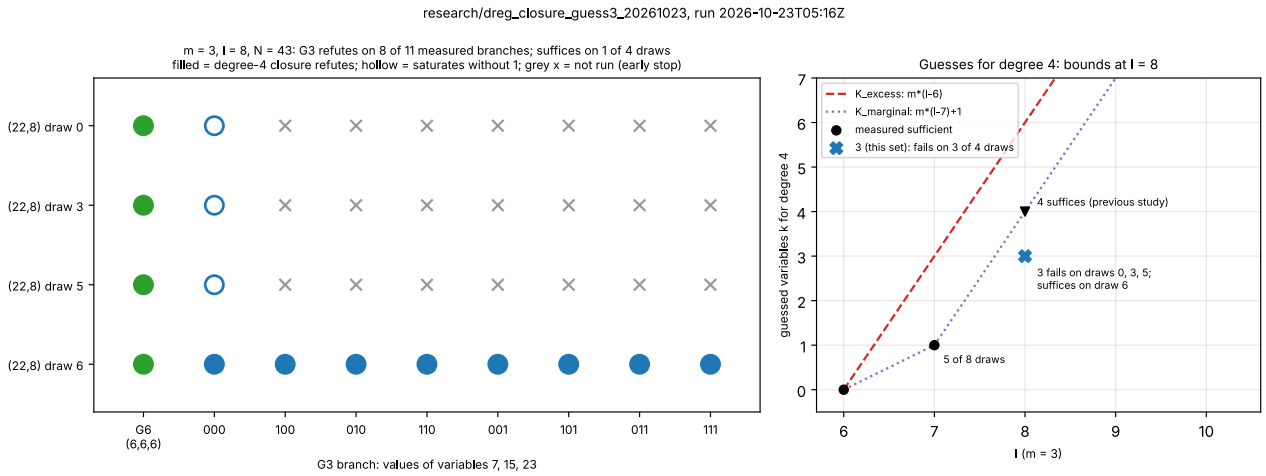

Figure 1: 4 draws × (G6 + 8 G3 branches), run 2026-10-23T05:16Z.

- **Registered verdict: three guesses do not suffice at ℓ = 8 (for this guess set).** 1 draw suffices, 3 do not. On draws 0, 3 and 5 the first branch saturates degree 4 without refuting (the other 7 were not run, by the registered stop rule); on draw 6 all 8 refute. Controls valid: N7 equals the committed record, G6 refutes on 4 of 4.
- **What it says:** three do not suffice for variables 7, 15, 23; four (7, 15, 23, 24) did in the previous study. Another three-variable set is unmeasured.
- **Reading (not registered):** the 3-set leaves every summand in dimension 7 at N = 43, structurally the ℓ = 7 systems that did not refute at degree 4 on 8 of 8 draws, so its failure is what that result predicts. The pattern fits `m·(ℓ−7)+1` guesses, 4 at ℓ = 8. Extended linearly that is 105 at the priced m = 4, ℓ = 33 cell against a break-even of 6. It rests on two values of ℓ and is an extrapolation, not a result.
- **ECC2K-130 (derived):** at the priced m = 4, ℓ = 33 cell (N = 394) the ratio `C(394, ≤5) / (2^k · C(394−k, ≤4))` is 78.2, 39.5, 19.95, 10.08, 5.09 for k = 0..4; the hybrid beats degree 5 only if k ≤ 6. No row moves, and no row beats rho.
- **Next:** the matched null (unspecialised (22, 7), same matrix size) and a 3-set that leaves one summand at dimension 8, both within this container; ℓ = 9, m = 4 at ℓ = 6 and degree 5 past ℓ = 7 need a larger host.